Annual Report 2023

Al-Rayhan Development Foundation

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> Synthetic document for demonstration and testing. All names, figures and organisations in it are fictional.

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About this edition

The Foundation publishes its annual report in Arabic for the communities and authorities it works with, and in English for international partners. This English edition follows the structure of the Arabic report, and its figures are the same.

Message from the Executive Director

2023 was the first year of our 2023–2027 strategy, and the year in which several long-running projects came to an end. We closed the Digital Pathways project and our second rural water project, both of which met or exceeded their targets. We also began the most ambitious programme in our history: a two-year cash assistance project that, for the first time, gives the poorest families a regular monthly transfer instead of one-off emergency help.

I am proud of what our teams achieved, but I also want to be honest about what we learned. Our tracer study of young people who trained with us in 2022 showed that finding a job is only half the challenge. Keeping that job, and earning a fair wage, is just as hard. The second phase of our youth employment programme, which starts in July 2024, has been redesigned around that lesson.

None of this would be possible without the trust of the communities we serve, the commitment of our 85 staff and 455 volunteers, and the support of our donors. Thank you.

Dr Karim Al-Attar (pseudonym)

Executive Director

2023 at a glance

Indicator	2023
People reached directly	63,400
Programmes	6
Governorates	6
Mobile clinics	6
Staff	85
Volunteers	455
Total income (USD)	5,230,000
Total expenditure (USD)	5,100,000

The number of people we reached directly grew by 8% compared with 2022. Most of the growth came from community health and from the new cash assistance project.

At the end of 2023 the Foundation employed 85 people, 47 of them women. Two thirds of our staff work in field offices in Wadi Al-Reem, the Eastern Plateau, Palm Plains and Sahl Al-Qamar.

We count each person once per programme, even if they received more than one service during the year.

Who we reached

Programme	2022	2023
Youth Employment Empowerment Programme	1,410	1,520
Rural Water, Sanitation and Hygiene Project	24,800	23,100
Girls' Basic Education Support Programme	4,650	4,900
Livelihoods Programme for Women Heads of Household	780	860
Community Health Programme	15,200	17,400
Social Protection and Cash Assistance Initiative	12,060	15,620
Total	**58,900**	**63,400**

Figures for the cash assistance initiative count all members of the households that received transfers: 2,890 households in 2023. Water and sanitation figures count the population of villages that gained a safe water point or took part in hygiene activities during the year.

Youth employment

In 2023, 1,520 young people completed training, 49% of them young women. Of these, 702 found work or started a business within six months, a placement rate of 46.2%.

Digital Pathways comes to a close

The Digital Pathways project (YEP-2021-03), funded by the Varnholt Foundation, ended on 30 June 2023. Over two years it trained 640 young people in digital skills, against a target of 600, and 54% of them found work. Almost half of the trainees were young women, helped by the transport allowance included in the project budget.

What happened to the class of 2022?

Following a recommendation of the 2022 final evaluation, we surveyed young people who completed training in 2022, one year after they finished. Of those we reached, 64% were in work twelve months on. Most of the rest had worked for some time but lost their jobs, usually because short contracts ended.

Phase 2

In December 2023 the Board approved the design of the second phase of the programme. It will start on 1 July 2024 and will combine youth employment and women's livelihoods into a single economic empowerment track, in line with the new strategy.

Water and sanitation

Our second water project, WASH-2020-02, funded by the Tilal Al-Anbar Development Fund, closed in August 2023 in 15 villages of Palm Plains. All 15 planned water points were completed, together with 2,100 household latrines. Village water committees, set up at the design stage, now run every water point. In total, water and sanitation activities reached 23,100 people in 2023.

No new water project started in 2023. The Foundation is preparing a proposal for villages on the edge of the Eastern Plateau, where the 2017 baseline survey found the greatest needs.

Girls' education

We supported 4,900 girls in 36 schools in Sahl Al-Qamar in 2023, using our own funds and private donations after the GEP-2019-02 project ended. The programme's focus is shifting from getting girls into school to improving what they learn, and to helping more girls move on to secondary school.

Fieldwork for the independent final evaluation of GEP-2019-02 was completed in November 2023. The report is expected in the first half of 2024.

Women's livelihoods

The WLP-2022-01 project, funded by the Bayariq Al-Nour Charitable Foundation, supported 860 women heads of household in Wadi Al-Reem and Marj Al-Zaafaran in 2023. Each woman received business training, a small start-up grant and six months of follow-up visits.

Our monitoring and evaluation unit carried out an internal evaluation of the women who joined the programme in 2021 and 2022. It found that nearly three quarters of their businesses were still trading a year later, and that monthly incomes had risen substantially. The full evaluation report is available in Arabic.

Community health

Our six mobile clinics reached 17,400 people in Palm Plains and the Eastern Plateau in 2023 and carried out 30,100 consultations, the highest number since the programme began in 2016. Free essential medicines for children, pregnant women and older people, introduced in 2022, remained one of the most valued services.

At the end of the year we began preparing an independent evaluation of the programme's results from 2021 to 2023, to be completed in 2024.

Social protection and cash assistance

In April 2023 we signed the SPC-2023-01 agreement with the Tilal Al-Anbar Development Fund. The grant is worth USD 1,400,000 over 24 months, from 1 May 2023 to 30 April 2025.

For the first time, the project gives eligible households a regular transfer of USD 75 per month for six months, instead of a single emergency payment. It aims to reach 2,600 households over the two years.

What we did in 2023

- The first 700 households began receiving monthly transfers in July 2023.
- A winter grant of USD 60 reached a further 2,190 households, funded by individual and corporate donations.
- Altogether, 2,890 households received cash assistance during the year.

Listening to recipients

Every household is told how to raise a complaint or ask a question, by phone, through local committees or online at https://example.org/feedback. In 2024 we will run a satisfaction survey of households in the first cohorts.

Financial summary

Income	USD
Grants from institutional donors	4,150,000
Individual and corporate donations	640,000
Own income	440,000
Total income	**5,230,000**

Expenditure	USD
Youth Employment Empowerment Programme	1,240,000
Rural Water, Sanitation and Hygiene Project	760,000
Girls' Basic Education Support Programme	690,000
Livelihoods Programme for Women Heads of Household	700,000
Community Health Programme	830,000
Social Protection and Cash Assistance Initiative	470,000
Administration and support costs	410,000
Total expenditure	**5,100,000**

Administration and support costs were 8.0% of total expenditure, within the Board's ceiling of 10%. The surplus of USD 130,000 was added to the operating reserve.

Governance

The Board of Directors, chaired by Hala Mansour (pseudonym), met four times in 2023. Besides approving the audited 2022 accounts, it approved the design of the second phase of the youth employment programme. In December 2023 it also approved the Foundation's budget for 2024, totalling USD 5,480,000, after revising the draft prepared by management in October.

Our partners in 2023

Tilal Al-Anbar Development Fund · Varnholt Foundation · Bayariq Al-Nour Charitable Foundation · Quillmere Health Fund · Thornvale Education Trust · Sidrat Al-Wadi Development Fund, together with the education and health directorates, local councils and many individual donors.

Looking ahead to 2024

- Launch phase 2 of the youth employment programme on 1 July 2024.
- Reach the remaining households under SPC-2023-01 and survey recipients' satisfaction.
- Publish the evaluations of the community health programme and of GEP-2019-02.
- Prepare a new water and sanitation proposal for the Eastern Plateau.

Contact

https://example.org · info@example.org